FOR THE PERSON PLAYING THE INTERVIEWER

You don't need to know anything about consulting.

This binder gives you everything a real interviewer has: what to say, what information to hand over and when, what a good answer sounds like, and how to score it. Your partner does the thinking. You hold the facts and keep the clock.

What a case interview is, in 30 seconds

Consulting firms test candidates with a short business puzzle, called a **case**. You read out a client's problem, for example "a hot dog stand is losing money, why?". The candidate has to ask good questions, organize the problem, do some math out loud, and end with a clear recommendation. It's a test of **how they think**, not of business trivia.

Your job, in one line each

- **Read** the blue *Say* lines out loud, word for word if you like.
- **Answer** questions using the *If they ask* tables. Anything not on the list: "Not important for this case, make an assumption."
- **Hold back** the yellow *Give* boxes until the moment described. Never volunteer data early.
- **Tick** the *Listen for* boxes as you hear them. That is your evidence for scoring.
- **Never show** the green *Answer key*. It's for you to check the candidate's numbers.
- **Score** at the end with the rubric, then give feedback: 2 strengths, 2 things to fix.

The colors in every case

SAY

Words you read out loud.

GIVE ONLY WHEN…

Data you hand over (read it, or show this box) only when the trigger happens.

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The right numbers and what a strong answer contains.

IF THEY'RE STUCK

Hints in order. Give one, wait 30 seconds, then the next.

HOW TO STEER

What the casebook says to do at this point, e.g. "after their framework, tell them the problem is only internal." Follow it so the case goes where it should.

FULL LIST · ASK IF THIN · IF THEY SAY…

A complete checklist to tick (so you see exactly what they missed), follow-up questions to dig deeper when an answer is short, and replies to common mistakes. Use probes before hints: probes make them think, hints give the answer away.

ADDED PARTLY ADDED mark steps, data and answers that go beyond the AUBCC casebook. A line under the step says exactly what was added.

Before you start (2 minutes)

- [ ] Pick a case you haven't read with them. Start with an **Easy** one.
- [ ] Read the case once to yourself, start to finish (about 5 minutes).
- [ ] Give the candidate paper, a pen and a calculator-free zone (no phone calculator; real interviews don't allow one).
- [ ] Sit across a table. Start a timer. Aim for 20–25 minutes per case.
- [ ] Keep a straight, friendly face. Real interviewers don't react much.

THE SIX STAGES

Every case follows the same shape

Each case script below walks you through these stages. Knowing the shape helps you notice when the candidate skips one.

1 You read the prompt

Read slowly. A good candidate writes it down and then repeats it back in their own words. If they don't, tick it as missed.

2 They ask clarifying questions

Usually 2–4 questions: about the goal, the client, the market. Answer from the *If they ask* table. More than ~6 questions is too many.

3 They build a framework

They'll ask for a minute or two of silence. Say "Sure, take your time." Then they explain how they'll break the problem into parts (for example "revenue" and "costs"). Compare with the Answer key.

4 Analysis and math

They ask for data, or estimate it themselves. You give the yellow boxes. They calculate out loud. You check against the Answer key.

5 Insight: "so what?"

After each number, a strong candidate says what it means for the client. If they don't, ask: "What does that mean for the client?"

6 Recommendation

You say the closing line. They should give the answer **first**, then 2–3 reasons, then risks and next steps. Under a minute.

Timing guide for a 25-minute case

Stage	Target	If it runs long
Prompt + questions	2–3 min	"Let's get going. What's your approach?"
Framework	2–4 min	"Which part would you look at first?"
Analysis and math	10–15 min	Give the next hint from the script.

Recommendation	1–2 min	"In one sentence: yes or no?"
Your feedback	5 min	Rubric + 2 strengths, 2 fixes.

Golden rules

1. Make them ask

Data comes out only when they ask for it, or when the script says "give if their estimate is way off". Asking for the right data is part of the test.

2. Let them estimate first

Many cases are **candidate-led**: they should make up reasonable numbers first. Only give the real number if theirs is far off (each script says what "far off" means), or if they ask directly.

3. Don't confirm too fast

When they get a number right, say "Okay, keep going." When it's wrong, say "Can you double-check that?" Never tell them the right number until they've tried twice.

4. Silence is fine

When they ask for time, give it: real interviewers wait. Only speak up after about 60 seconds of total silence.

5. Push back once

Once per case, ask "Why?" or "Are you sure?" even when they're right. It tests whether they stay calm and can defend their logic.

6. Hints in order

If they're stuck, use the red hint boxes one at a time. Every hint you give costs a point on "Drive" in the rubric. Note how many you gave.

Phrase bank

They ask for time to think	"Sure, take a minute."
They ask something not in your script	"Good question, but it's not important here. Make a reasonable assumption."
They ask "Is that right?"	"What do you think?" or "Walk me through how you got there."
They're silent for a long time	"Can you walk me through what you're thinking?"
They ramble or go off-track	"Let's focus. What do you need to answer the client's question?"

They finish a calculation and stop	"So what does that mean for the client?"
They made a math mistake	"Can you double-check that last step?"
They ask you to just give the number	"What would you estimate?" (Give it if the script says so.)
Time is running out	"The CEO just walked in. What's your recommendation?"

USE THIS FOR EVERY CASE

Scoring rubric

Score each area from 1 to 5. A 3 means "would probably pass at a first-round interview". Use the ticks from the case script as evidence. Be honest: a generous score doesn't help them.

Area	1–2: Weak	3: Pass	4–5: Strong
Structure	Jumps into numbers with no plan. Framework is a generic list or misses big pieces.	Clear framework with 2–4 parts that fit the case. Some overlap or gaps.	Framework is tailored to this client, has no overlaps or gaps, and is explained in under 2 minutes. Says which part to look at first and why.
Math	Wrong answers, messy, silent working, or needs a calculator.	Correct with maybe one slip they fix themselves. Talks through steps.	Fast, correct, clean units (per day, per year, $M). Rounds sensibly and announces each step out loud.
Business sense	Reports numbers without meaning. Misses the key insight even after hints.	Explains what numbers mean when asked. Finds the insight with one hint.	Says "so what" on their own, sanity-checks results ("that seems high because..."), spots the key insight unprompted.
Communication	Hard to follow, rambles, recommendation is vague or missing.	Clear enough. Recommendation exists but is buried or long.	Answer-first, organized ("three reasons: first..."), confident, under a minute to close.
Drive	Waits for you to lead. Needed 3+ hints.	Mostly leads. Needed 1–2 hints.	Leads the whole case, asks for the right data at the right time, suggests next steps. No hints needed.

Reading the total (out of 25)

- **21–25**: Offer-level. Move to harder cases.
- **16–20**: Solid. Fix the lowest area.
- **11–15**: Getting there. Redo this case type in a few days.

- **5–10**: Practice the basics: frameworks and mental math.

How to give feedback (5 minutes)

1. Ask them first: "How do you think that went?"
2. Share **2 things they did well**, with specific moments ("you caught that the 75–80 age group is 5 years").
3. Share **2 things to fix**, again specific ("you didn't say what the −$100 meant for the owner").
4. Read them the total score and their lowest area.

PLAIN-ENGLISH GLOSSARY

Words the candidate will use

You don't need to use these. It just helps to know what they mean when you hear them.

Framework / structure	Their plan for breaking the problem into parts.
MECE	"Mutually exclusive, collectively exhaustive": parts that don't overlap and together cover everything. Interviewers love it.
Revenue	Money coming in. Usually price × quantity sold.
Costs: fixed vs. variable	Fixed costs don't change with sales (rent). Variable costs grow with each unit sold (food in each hot dog).
Profit	Revenue minus costs.
Profit margin	Profit as a % of revenue. $10 profit on $100 revenue = 10% margin.
COGS	"Cost of goods sold": what it costs to make the product itself.
Payback period	Years needed to earn back an investment. Investment ÷ yearly profit.
Breakeven	The point where revenue exactly covers costs (profit = 0).
Market sizing	Estimating how big a market is, e.g. "how much is spent on diapers per year".
Market share	The % of a market one company holds.
Market entry	A case about whether a company should start selling in a new market.
Barriers to entry	Things that make it hard to enter a market: licenses, laws, big competitors.

Cross-selling	Selling a second product to an existing customer.
Sanity check	Asking "does this number make sense?" before moving on.
Price elasticity	How much customers buy less when the price goes up.
"So what?"	What a number means for the client's decision.

PICK ONE

The cases

Start with an Easy case. Read the script once on your own before you begin. Each takes 15–25 minutes plus 5 minutes of feedback.

Diapers in KSA

Market sizing · Easy · ~20 min

Hot Dog Stand

Profitability · Easy · ~25 min

Concert in Riyadh

Profitability · Easy · ~25 min

Billionaire Banker

Market entry · Easy · ~25 min

TV Family Business

Market entry · Medium · ~25 min

Plane Ticket Price

Pricing · Medium · ~25 min

Energy Consumption

Discussion · Hard · ~25 min

KSA Retail Bank

Profitability · Hard · ~30 min

Lebanese Cryptocurrency

Market entry · Medium · ~25 min

Hair Loss Pill

Profitability · Medium · ~25 min

CASE 1 OF 10

Diapers in KSA

Market sizing | Easy | ~20 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A global consumer goods company is thinking about building a diaper factory in Saudi Arabia. First the candidate estimates how big the diaper market is, then judges whether the factory is worth it.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

The market is about **$2.3 billion a year**. At 10% share and 15% margin the $100M factory pays back in **about 3 years** (longer once retailer margins are counted). Recommendation: promising, worth validating.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The client (a consumer goods company weighing a factory in KSA) is added. The casebook only asks for the market size.

SAY

"Our client is a large international consumer goods company that makes baby and adult hygiene products. They don't sell in Saudi Arabia today, and they're considering building a factory there to enter the market."

"Before anything else, the CEO wants to know how big the opportunity is. Estimate the market size of diapers in KSA."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Do we include adult diapers?	"Yes, elderly people are included."
Cloth or disposable?	"Only consider disposable diapers."
Value or number of diapers?	"Market size should be done by sales, not volume. In dollars, per year."
What's the client's end goal? ADDED	"To decide whether the market is big enough to justify a local factory. We'll get to that."
Who are the competitors? ADDED	"Several international and local brands. You don't need them for the sizing."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Plays back the situation and the goal (size the market, then decide on the factory)
- [ ] Asks if adult diapers count
- [ ] Confirms sales in dollars per year, not volume

2 Approach

2–3 min

SAY

"How would you approach the sizing?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: this is an interviewee-led case. Ask the candidate to estimate the numbers. If they're in the right ballpark, they should use their own numbers. Give the casebook numbers only if their estimates are far off.
- The casebook's expected approach: dissect the population of KSA by age group and proceed from there.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Lays out the steps before using any numbers
- [ ] Splits the population by age
- [ ] Includes babies (0–3) AND elderly
- [ ] Uses % of each group using diapers, then diapers per day
- [ ] Converts to a year and multiplies by price

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Who uses diapers besides babies?"
- "How will you get from number of people to dollars?"
- "Will everyone in an age group use diapers?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Population → people per year of age (population ÷ life expectancy) → users in each relevant age group (babies 0–3, elderly) → diapers per day → per year → × price per diaper.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Who uses diapers?"
2. "Could you split the population into groups?"
3. "Try splitting by age."

3 Population

2 min

SAY

"That sounds reasonable. Go ahead. What numbers would you use for the population?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: IF THEY ASK, OR IF THEIR POPULATION IS UNDER 25M OR OVER 45M, OR LIFE EXPECTANCY IS UNDER 70 OR OVER 85.

Exhibit 1. Population of KSA: **35 million**. Life expectancy: **80 years**. For simplicity, assume the same number of people at every age.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Divides population by life expectancy
- [ ] Rounds to a workable number (~450k)

IF THEY SAY… YOU SAY

Uses a population far from 35M	"KSA's population is about 35 million. Let's use that."

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`35M ÷ 80 ≈ 437,500 → round to ~450k per year of age`

4 Diapers per day

4–5 min

SAY

"Now get me to the number of diapers used each day."

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK HOW MANY PEOPLE USE DIAPERS OR HOW MANY THEY USE, OR IF THEIR USAGE ESTIMATES ARE FAR OFF.

Exhibit 2. Diaper usage by age group

Age group	0–1	1–2	2–3	75–80
Diaper use (%)	100%	90%	80%	30%
Average quantity per day	10	8	6	4

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Notices 75–80 is FIVE years of people (2.25M), not one
- [ ] Works group by group, out loud
- [ ] Gets ~12.6M diapers per day

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] 0–1: 450k × 100% × 10 = 4.5M
- [ ] 1–2: 450k × 90% × 8 ≈ 3.2M
- [ ] 2–3: 450k × 80% × 6 ≈ 2.2M
- [ ] 75–80: 2.25M × 30% × 4 = 2.7M

IF THEY SAY… YOU SAY

Uses 450k people for the 75–80 group	"How many years of age are in the 75–80 group?"
Forgets the elderly	"You said elderly were included. Where are they?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Group	People	× use	× per day	= per day
0–1	450k	100%	10	4.5M
1–2	450k	90%	8	3.2M
2–3	450k	80%	6	2.2M
75–80	2.25M	30%	4	2.7M

Total ≈ **12.6M diapers per day**.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many years of age are in the 75–80 group?"
2. "Take one age group at a time."

5 Market value

2 min

SAY

"One pack of 12 diapers costs $6. What's the market worth per year?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Multiplies by 365
- [ ] Price per diaper = $0.50
- [ ] States the answer clearly: about $2.3 billion a year

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

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12.6M × 365 ≈ 4.6B diapers a year
4.6B × $6/12 = 4.6B × $0.50 ≈ $2.3B a year
```

6 Sanity check ADDED

2 min

SAY

"Does that number feel right to you? What could make it too high or too low?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Babies are ~80% of volume, so baby assumptions matter most
- [ ] Even age split understates babies: KSA has a young population, so the market is likely bigger
- [ ] Elderly use may start before 75
- [ ] Prices vary between premium and discount brands

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Is KSA's population really spread evenly by age?"
- "Which assumption, if wrong, changes the answer most?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

A strong candidate challenges their own number: "KSA's population skews young, so I'm probably underestimating babies. I'd call $2.3B a conservative estimate."

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Which group drives most of the volume?"
2. "Is KSA's population really spread evenly by age?"

7 The factory decision ADDED

3–4 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: 10% share, 15% margin and the $100M factory are new.

SAY

"Let's get back to the client's question. They believe they can win 10% of the market within three years, at a 15% operating margin. The factory would cost $100 million. How long would it take to pay back?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 10% share = $230M revenue
- [ ] 15% margin = ~$34.5M profit a year
- [ ] Payback ≈ 2.9 years
- [ ] Spots that $2.3B is the store price: the client sells to retailers at a lower price, so real revenue is lower and payback longer
- [ ] Notes that share builds up over time, so the first years earn less

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Is the $2.3B what the client would actually receive?"
- "Will they hit 10% in year one?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
10% × $2.3B = $230M revenue
× 15% = $34.5M profit a year
$100M ÷ $34.5M ≈ 2.9 years
```

The best candidates add: "Retailers keep part of the $6, maybe 25–30%, so our revenue is closer to $160–170M and payback is nearer 4 years. That's still attractive."

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What revenue does 10% of the market give the client?"
2. "Payback is the investment divided by yearly profit."

8 What else to check ADDED

2–3 min

SAY

"What else would you want to know before recommending the factory?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Competitors: who leads, how loyal customers are to brands
- [ ] Distribution: pharmacies, hypermarkets, online
- [ ] Is 10% share realistic for a new entrant?
- [ ] Government incentives for local manufacturing, Saudization rules
- [ ] Demand trend: birth rate, aging population
- [ ] Option to import first, build later

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Can you group those ideas?"
- "What could stop them reaching 10%?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Look for organized answers, for example market / competition / operations / risks, not a random list.

9 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"The CEO is walking in. You have one minute. Should they build the factory?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first (yes, with conditions)
- [ ] Reasons: ~$2.3B market, ~3–4 year payback
- [ ] Risks: the 10% share assumption, retailer margins
- [ ] Next steps: competitor analysis, distribution partners, local incentives

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

"I recommend moving ahead with the factory, subject to two checks. The KSA diaper market is about $2.3B a year, probably more given the young population. At 10% share, the $100M factory pays back in 3–4 years. Next, I'd validate that 10% share is achievable against current brands, and lock in distribution and any local manufacturing incentives."

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 2 OF 10

Hot Dog Stand

Profitability | Easy | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A hot dog stand that used to make money now loses money. The candidate maps the stand's revenue and costs, finds it loses $100 a month, sees that sales fell because of a competitor's student deal and that food waste rose, and suggests fixes.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

The stand **loses $100 a month** ($2,700 revenue – $2,800 costs). The clearest fix is the **$200 of expired food** (inventory planning). Behind it: **5 fewer meals a day** than last year, lost to Frank's $5 student combo. Compete on value, not a price cut.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: 'This month it lost money' and the $700/month goal are added.

SAY

"Our client owns a single hot dog stand in Hamra, Beirut. It has been experiencing a decline in profitability over the past few months, and this month it actually lost money."

"The owner wants to know what the problem is and what to do about it."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

What do they sell, at what price?	"A standard meal: a hot dog and a drink for $6. The price hasn't changed in two years."
Who are the competitors? Are they affected?	"Our direct competitor is Frank's Hot Dog, and they're not facing any problem. Indirect competitors are Roadster Diner and other restaurants."
Has anything changed recently? ADDED	"Nothing the owner can point to. That's why they called us."
What's the goal? ADDED	"Get back to at least last year's profit, about $700 a month."
Any fixed costs or investments?	"Disregard fixed costs: the truck has been running for a while."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Plays back: one stand in Hamra, profit decline, now a loss
- [ ] Asks whether competitors are affected (Frank's is fine)
- [ ] Asks about price and product

2 Framework PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The casebook gives no framework; this one follows its revenue-and-costs solution.

SAY

"How would you structure this?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: this is a typical profitability case. Start by computing the profit: find the revenues and the costs.
- Because Frank's is fine, lead them to look inside our stand first.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profit = revenue − costs
- [ ] Revenue = price × number of meals (plus other revenue streams)
- [ ] Costs split into fixed and variable
- [ ] Uses the competitor as a benchmark: Frank's is fine, so the problem is likely ours
- [ ] Plans to compare with the past to see what changed

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Where does the stand's money come from?"
- "Where does it go?"
- "How would you know what changed?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Revenue: price, meals sold, other streams. **Costs**: fixed (truck, paid off) and variable (food, utilities, rent, labor, expired food). **External**: competitors (Frank's is fine, so it's internal).

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What is profit made of?"
2. "How would you find out what changed?"

3 Revenue streams

2 min

SAY

"Let's start with revenue. What revenue streams could a hot dog stand have?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate can list other revenue streams, but we only consider the standard meal for the solution. Once they've listed them, say: "Good ideas. Today they only sell the standard meal, so let's focus on that."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] The standard meal (hot dog + drink)
- [ ] At least 2 other streams

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Standard meal: hot dog + drink
- [ ] Ads on the truck
- [ ] Delivery service
- [ ] Hot dog toppings / add-ons
- [ ] New products on the menu

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Could the truck itself make money?"
- "What could they sell besides the meal?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Today: only the standard meal. Possible others (casebook): ads on the truck, delivery, toppings, new products.

4 Monthly revenue

2 min

SAY

"How many meals do you think they sell per day? What's the monthly revenue?"

HOW TO STEER

- Candidate-led: let them estimate. Give the real figure if they ask, or if their estimate is below 5 or above 60 meals a day.

GIVE ONLY WHEN: IF THEY ASK, OR IF THEIR ESTIMATE IS FAR OFF.

The stand sells **15 meals per day**.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] $6 × 15 = $90 a day
- [ ] × 30 days = $2,700 a month

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`$6 × 15 meals = $90/day → × 30 = $2,700/month`

5 Cost structure PARTLY ADDED

3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The cost list is the casebook's; the fixed-vs-variable question is added.

SAY

"Now costs. What costs does the stand have, and which are fixed versus variable?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: AFTER THEY BRAINSTORM. READ THE FULL LIST.

Exhibit 1. Costs

- Fixed costs: disregard (the truck has been running for a while)
- Variable costs (related to daily operations):
  - Cost of goods sold (COGS): 3× pricing strategy
  - Utilities (gas and electricity): $400 per month
  - Rent: $800 per month
  - Labor (1 chef): $500 per month
  - Expired food: $200 per month

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Brainstorms food, staff, rent, utilities, waste before seeing the list
- [ ] Asks what "3× pricing" means, or works out food = $2 a meal
- [ ] Discusses fixed vs. variable sensibly

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Food / ingredients (COGS)
- [ ] Utilities (gas, electricity)
- [ ] Rent
- [ ] Labor (chef)
- [ ] Expired / wasted food
- [ ] The truck itself (fixed, already paid)

IF THEY SAY… YOU SAY

"Rent and salary are fixed, not variable"	"Fair point. The casebook groups them as daily operating costs. What matters is the total."
Confused by "3× pricing"	"It means the selling price is three times what the food costs."

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Food cost = $6 ÷ 3 = **$2 per meal**. Strictly, rent and the chef's salary are fixed each month; the casebook calls them variable because they're operating costs. Either way they count.

6 This month's profit

2–3 min

SAY

"So what's the stand's monthly profit?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Food: $2 × 15 × 30 = $900
- [ ] Total costs: 900 + 400 + 800 + 500 + 200 = $2,800
- [ ] Profit = 2,700 − 2,800 = −$100 (a loss)
- [ ] Points out the $200 of expired food is larger than the loss

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Costs: 900 + 400 + 800 + 500 + 200 = $2,800/month
Profit: 2,700 − 2,800 = −$100/month
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Add up all the monthly costs."

7 Last year vs. this year ADDED

3–4 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The whole 'last year' column is new.

SAY

"The owner also shared last year's numbers for the same month. What was profit then, and what changed?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 2. Monthly figures (30 days)

	Last year	This year
Meals sold per day	20	15
Price per meal	$6	$6
Food cost per meal	$2	$2
Rent	$800	$800
Chef salary	$500	$500
Utilities	$350	$400
Expired food	$50	$200

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Last year: +$700 a month
- [ ] Profit fell $800: revenue −$900, food bought +$300 saved, waste −$150, utilities −$50
- [ ] Main problem is volume: 5 fewer meals a day (−25%)
- [ ] Links waste to volume: still buying for 20 meals, selling 15

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Which line moved the most?"
- "Why would expired food go up when sales went down?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Last year: 3,600 − 1,200 − (800+500+350+50) = +$700
This year: −$100 → a drop of $800
```

Volume is the main problem; waste is the second, and they're linked.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Work out last year line by line."
2. "Which line moved the most?"

8 Why customers left ADDED

3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The customer survey is new.

SAY

"Volume is down a quarter. Why might that be? After your ideas, I'll share what customers told us."

GIVE ONLY WHEN: AFTER THEY BRAINSTORM REASONS.

Exhibit 3. "Why did you switch to Frank's?" (100 former customers)

Reason	Share
Frank's new $5 student combo (hot dog, drink and fries)	45%
Our wait time is too long at lunch	25%
Frank's has more menu choices	20%
Other	10%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Organizes reasons: internal (quality, speed, hours) vs. external (competitor, foot traffic, economy)
- [ ] Reads the survey: value is the main issue, wait time is fixable
- [ ] 70% of reasons are value and service, not quality or location

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The competitor changed, not the market: Frank's launched a better-value student offer, and our service is slow.

9 Increasing profitability

3–4 min

SAY

"Given profits are in the red, how can we increase profitability? Give me a structured answer."

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate should come up with ways to increase profitability in a structured, cohesive way: increase revenues and decrease costs.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Splits into increase revenues / decrease costs
- [ ] Raise price, but mentions price elasticity
- [ ] More volume: marketing, new menu items
- [ ] New revenue streams such as advertising
- [ ] Cheaper location, but notes location is key
- [ ] Cut COGS without hurting quality
- [ ] Spots the $200 expired food: forecast demand and order less

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Increase prices (consider price elasticity)
- [ ] Increase volume: marketing, new menu items
- [ ] Add new revenue streams, e.g. advertising
- [ ] Change location to cut rent (risky: location is key)
- [ ] Reduce COGS without reducing quality
- [ ] Inventory: forecast monthly demand to cut the $200 of expired food

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Look at the cost list again. Is anything avoidable?"
- "What could they do about Frank's student deal?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Increase revenues: price (watch elasticity), volume (marketing, new items), new streams (ads).

Decrease costs: location (risky), COGS (keep quality), and above all **inventory**: $200 of expired food a month; forecast demand from monthly trends.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Look at the cost list again. Is any of it avoidable?"

10 Should they cut the price? ADDED

3 min

SAY

"The owner wants to match Frank's at $5. Food cost stays $2. Suppose they fix waste back to $50 a month. How many meals a day would they need to break even at $5?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Margin per meal falls from $4 to $3
- [ ] Costs to cover: 800 + 500 + 400 + 50 = $1,750
- [ ] Breakeven ≈ 583 a month ≈ 19–20 a day: they'd need almost all lost customers back
- [ ] At $6 with waste fixed, breakeven is ~14.6 a day, below today's 15

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`$1,750 ÷ $3 ≈ 583/month ≈ 19.4/day (at $5)`

`$1,750 ÷ $4 ≈ 438/month ≈ 14.6/day (at $6)`

Matching on value (a combo) is safer than cutting the price.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How much does the stand keep from each meal at $5?"

11 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"The owner walks up. What do you tell them?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: loses ~$100 a month; lost 5 meals a day to Frank's student deal, and over-orders food
- [ ] Action 1: forecast demand and order less (saves ~$150 a month)
- [ ] Action 2: a value combo or student offer at $6, not a price cut
- [ ] Action 3: faster lunch service
- [ ] Next step: track daily sales and waste for a month

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 3 OF 10

Concert in Riyadh

Profitability | Easy | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

An events company is offered a one-night DJ concert in Riyadh. It must make at least $10,000 to be worth their time. Full house it makes $15,800, but based on their past events it would make about $9,100, so it only works with some extra income.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Full house: **$15,800** profit ($38,000 – $22,200). At realistic sales (VIP 70%, regular 90%): **$9,140**, just under the **$10,000** bar. Go ahead only if they add ~$1–2k of extra income (F&B, merch, a sponsor) and secure the license.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The two-week deadline is added.

SAY

"Our client is an entertainment company that wants to host a concert in Riyadh with a famous DJ, one night only."

"They have come to us to see if it's a good idea or not, and need to decide within two weeks."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

What's their goal? ADDED	"They only take on events that make at least $10,000 profit."
How big is the venue?	"1,000 people: 400 VIP and 600 regular."
Where does the money come from?	"Tickets and sponsors. I have numbers when you need them."
Have they done this before? ADDED	"Yes, several events. We have data on those."
Any permits needed? ADDED	"Yes, an event license. Assume it's obtainable."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks for the profit target and finds the $10k bar
- [ ] Asks about capacity
- [ ] Asks about past events

2 Framework PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The casebook goes straight to the calculation; the framework question is added.

SAY

"How would you structure this?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: this is a typical profitability case. First compute the profit generated by the concert: revenues and costs. Then discuss the important aspects of the event.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profitability: revenue (tickets by tier, sponsors, extras) – costs (fixed and per ticket)
- [ ] Demand: how many tickets will really sell
- [ ] Feasibility: license, local regulations, culture
- [ ] Compares the result with the $10k bar

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Beyond the money, what could stop this event from working?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Profitability (revenues: tickets, sponsors, extras; costs: fixed, variable) / **Demand** (ticket sales) / **Feasibility** (license, regulations, culture).

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What would make this concert a success for the client?"

3 Revenue streams PARTLY ADDED

2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The extras are the casebook's 'additional revenue streams'; asking for them up front is added.

SAY

"What revenue streams could a concert like this have?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Ticket sales, by tier
- [ ] Sponsorships
- [ ] Extras: food and drinks, merchandise, parking

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Ticket sales (VIP and regular)
- [ ] Sponsors
- [ ] Accessories (glow sticks, t-shirts)
- [ ] Memorabilia of the DJ and other performers
- [ ] Restaurants and food carts
- [ ] Non-alcoholic drinks
- [ ] Valet parking

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Today the client counts on tickets and sponsors. Extras (food, drinks, merch, parking) come up again later.

4 Full-house revenue

3 min

SAY

"Let's start with the numbers. What revenue would the concert bring in if it sells out?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT TICKETS, PRICES OR SPONSORS.

Exhibit 1. Tickets and sponsors

	VIP	Regular
Tickets	400	600
Price	$50	$20

Sponsor	Amount
EJ Entertainment	$3,000
Sky Events	$2,000
DJDS Events	$1,000

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] VIP $20,000 + regular $12,000
- [ ] Sponsors $6,000
- [ ] Total $38,000

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
400 × $50 = $20,000
600 × $20 = $12,000
Sponsors = $6,000
Total = $38,000
```

5 Costs and profit

3 min

SAY

"And the costs? Which are fixed and which variable, and what's the profit if it sells out?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT COSTS.

Exhibit 2. Costs

- $3 commission PR affiliates make on each ticket sold
- DJ: $6,000
- Venue rent: $5,000
- Maintenance and insurance: $4,000
- Operational expenses: $4,200

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Fixed: DJ, venue, maintenance and insurance, operations = $19,200
- [ ] Variable: $3 × 1,000 tickets = $3,000
- [ ] Total costs $22,200 → profit $15,800
- [ ] Compares with the $10k bar: above it at full house

IF THEY SAY… YOU SAY

Treats the commission as fixed	"Does the commission depend on how many tickets sell?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Fixed: 6,000 + 5,000 + 4,000 + 4,200 = $19,200
Variable: $3 × 1,000 = $3,000
Profit = 38,000 − 22,200 = $15,800
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Which costs depend on tickets sold?"

6 Realistic sales ADDED

3–4 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Past sell-through (70% / 90%) and the $10k minimum are new.

SAY

"That assumes every ticket sells. Here's how the client's last three events sold. What profit should they expect?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY. (IF THEY ASKED ABOUT PAST SALES EARLIER, PRAISE THAT AND GIVE IT THEN.)

Exhibit 3. Average share of tickets sold, last three events

VIP	Regular
70%	90%

Sponsors pay the same regardless of attendance.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] VIP: 280 × $50 = $14,000
- [ ] Regular: 540 × $20 = $10,800
- [ ] Commission falls too: 820 × $3 = $2,460
- [ ] Expected profit ≈ $9,140: below the $10,000 bar

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Revenue: 14,000 + 10,800 + 6,000 = $30,800
Costs: 19,200 + 2,460 = $21,660
Profit = $9,140 (about $860 short)
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many VIP tickets is 70%?"
2. "Does the commission change?"

7 Important aspects

4 min

SAY

"This seems like a profitable idea. What are the important aspects of the event we have to address?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: a non-exhaustive list. The candidate might come up with other ideas; accept them if they're sensible.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Barriers to entry: license, local business regulations
- [ ] Culture and preferences of the target market
- [ ] How to sell the tickets to reach 100% occupancy
- [ ] Additional revenue streams

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] License to organize concert events
- [ ] Local business regulations (may need a local partner/patron)
- [ ] Culture: e.g. audience arrangements that respect local norms
- [ ] Ticket sales channels: online box office, local stores, social media
- [ ] Sales timeline: start selling 1, 3 or 6 months before
- [ ] Extra revenue: accessories (glow sticks, t-shirts)
- [ ] Extra revenue: DJ and performer memorabilia
- [ ] Extra revenue: restaurants and food carts
- [ ] Extra revenue: non-alcoholic drinks
- [ ] Extra revenue: valet parking

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "What do you need before you're even allowed to hold the event?"
- "How would you actually sell 1,000 tickets?"
- "Is there anything specific to Riyadh's audience?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Four groups (casebook): **1. Barriers to entry** (license, local regulations, local partner). **2. Culture and preferences**. **3. Selling out** (channels and timeline). **4. Additional revenue streams** (accessories, memorabilia, food, drinks, parking).

8 Closing the gap ADDED

2–3 min

SAY

"Realistically they're about $860 short of their $10,000 bar. How would you close that gap?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Uses extra revenue streams: one food stand or merch table covers it
- [ ] Another sponsor
- [ ] Early-bird presale to lift VIP sales
- [ ] Negotiate the DJ or venue fee, or the commission
- [ ] Sizes at least one idea

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Example: "500 people spending $5 at a food stand with a 50% margin is $1,250, which closes the gap on its own."

9 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"So, should they do it?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: yes, but only with extra income secured
- [ ] Full house $15.8k, realistic $9.1k: under the $10k bar
- [ ] Close the gap with a food concession or one more sponsor
- [ ] Secure the license; respect local norms; start ticket sales early

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 4 OF 10

Billionaire Banker

Market entry | Easy | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A real-estate billionaire with no banking experience wants to enter Saudi banking. The candidate looks at competitors, barriers and market share, finds the two ways to enter (build or buy), compares their payback, and recommends based on risk.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

New bank: **6.8 years** payback (8.8 with 2 years to launch). Buying a bank: **8 years**, but safer (existing customers, real profits). Casebook answer: **it depends on the client's risk appetite**. Added catch: the target lends 35% to real estate, which works against the client's diversification goal.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The real-estate background and the $25M budget are added.

SAY

"Your client is a Saudi billionaire who made their fortune in real estate. They're considering entering the Saudi banking sector and have up to $25 million to invest."

"Should they do it or not? What are the factors that should be considered?"

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Does the client have banking experience?	"No, no past experience in the banking industry."
How competitive is the market?	"The Saudi banking market is relatively saturated, but there's still room for an entrant like our client."
Are there regulations in the way?	"There are no new regulations preventing entry. Saudization should be considered for this entry."
Why banking? ADDED	"They want to diversify away from real estate."
What's their objective? ADDED	"A long-term business. They prefer to avoid big risks."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Finds the client has no banking experience
- [ ] Asks about regulation and Saudization
- [ ] Asks about the client's motive and risk appetite

2 Framework

2–3 min

SAY

"What factors would you look at?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: this is more of a discussion case. Any interesting information the candidate gives can be taken into consideration.
- The candidate should target three buckets: competitors, barriers to entry, market size and share.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Competitors: who they are, how established, their goals, trends
- [ ] Barriers to entry: Saudi partner (Saudization), regulations
- [ ] Market size and share: share we could win, competitors' shares

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Who are the competitors? Are they well established in KSA?
- [ ] Do competitors have the same goals as our client?
- [ ] Market trends, alternatives and future projections
- [ ] Do we need a Saudi partner to enter? (Saudization)
- [ ] Any regulations set by the government?
- [ ] What market share could the client get after entering?
- [ ] What are competitors' market shares?

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "What could make it hard for a newcomer to enter?"
- "How much of the market could the client realistically win?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Competitors (who, how established, their goals, trends and projections) / **Barriers to entry** (Saudi partner for Saudization, government regulations) / **Market size and share** (our potential share, competitors' shares).

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What could stop a newcomer from succeeding in banking?"

3 The market ADDED

3 min

SAY

"Here's an overview of the market. What does it tell you?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT THE MARKET OR COMPETITORS.

Exhibit 1. Saudi retail banking (illustrative)

Indicator	Value
Sector profit growth	~6% a year
Share of deposits held by top 5 banks	75%
Fastest-growing segments	Digital banking, small-business lending

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Growing and profitable
- [ ] Concentrated: hard to win share from scratch
- [ ] Opportunity in niches: digital, small businesses

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Attractive but concentrated: a saturated market with high barriers for a newcomer, with some room in niches.

4 Ways to enter

2 min

SAY

"How could the client actually get into banking?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: guide the candidate to the realization that there are 2 ways to enter the market, and that they must study the profitability of each.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Start a bank from scratch (organic / greenfield)
- [ ] Acquire an existing player
- [ ] Bonus: a partnership or joint venture

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Does the client have to start from zero?"
- "Could they buy their way in?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Two ways: **build** a new bank (greenfield), or **buy** an existing player.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Does the client have to build a bank from zero?"

5 Profitability of each

4 min

SAY

"Here are the numbers for both options. What's the payback period of each?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 2. Entry options

Option 1: open our own bank	Option 2: acquire an existing player
Initial investment: $15M	Cost of acquisition: $20M
Yearly revenues: $10M	Yearly profit: $2.5M
Profit margin: 22%	

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Option 1 profit = $10M × 22% = $2.2M a year
- [ ] Option 1 payback = 15 ÷ 2.2 ≈ 6.8 years
- [ ] Option 2 payback = 20 ÷ 2.5 = 8 years

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Option 1: $10M × 22% = $2.2M → 15 ÷ 2.2 ≈ 6.8 years
Option 2: 20 ÷ 2.5 = 8 years
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What's the yearly profit of Option 1?"
2. "Payback is investment divided by yearly profit."

6 Risk of each

3 min

SAY

"So Option 1 pays back faster. Is it the better choice?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: this is the real test. Building is risky because the client has no experience or credibility. Acquiring is safer because the player has an established customer base, but there's a concern about its profitability.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Doesn't just pick the faster option
- [ ] Option 1: risky; no experience, no credibility, the $10M is only a forecast
- [ ] Option 2: safer; established customer base, real profits
- [ ] Says it depends on the client's risk appetite

IF THEY SAY… YOU SAY

"Yes, 6.8 is less than 8, so build."	"How sure are we of the $10M revenue for a brand-new bank with no track record?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Opening a bank means the revenues, and so the profits, are forecast; the money isn't actually there. With an acquisition, the customer base exists and the money is there, so the risk is lower.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How sure are we of the $10M revenue for a brand-new bank?"

7 Launch delay ADDED

2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The 2-year launch and 300 Saudization hires are new.

SAY

"One more fact: getting a banking license, hiring and launching takes about two years, and the new bank would need to hire around 300 staff to meet Saudization. The bank for sale already complies and earns from day one. Does that change the comparison?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 6.8 years of profit + 2 years before earning ≈ 8.8 years
- [ ] Now slower than buying (8 years) as well as riskier
- [ ] Saudization hiring adds cost and time to building

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`Option 1: 6.8 + 2 ≈ 8.8 years vs. Option 2: 8 years`

8 The catch ADDED

3 min

SAY

"Buying looks better. Here's one more thing from the target bank's accounts. Any concerns?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 3. Target bank loan book

Sector	Share of loans
Real estate developers and mortgages	35%
Personal loans	30%
Small businesses	20%
Other	15%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 35% real estate is high
- [ ] The client wanted to diversify AWAY from real estate: this deepens the exposure
- [ ] A property downturn would hit both the client's wealth and the bank
- [ ] Suggests due diligence, or reducing that share after buying

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The acquisition works against the client's own objective unless the real-estate exposure is reduced.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Why did the client want to enter banking in the first place?"

9 Recommendation PARTLY ADDED

1–2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Risk appetite is the casebook's answer; the real-estate condition is added.

SAY

"What's your recommendation?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: an important factor is the client's risk appetite. It depends on what the client wants.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first, tied to risk appetite: for a risk-averse client, acquire
- [ ] Reasons: established customers and proven profit, Saudization compliance, and faster once the launch delay counts
- [ ] Condition: reduce the real-estate loan exposure
- [ ] Next steps: due diligence, valuation, keep the management team

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 5 OF 10

TV Family Business

Market entry | Medium | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A Dubai family business wants to buy a TV channel and earn back the price within 5 years. The full ad-slot math says exactly 5 years, but not every slot sells, so it's really 7.5. The candidate finds ways to speed up payback and the right price to pay.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Theoretical revenue $9M → payback 5 years. The limit is **demand**: not all ad slots sell; actual revenue **$8M → 7.5 years**, which fails the goal. Speed it up with subscriptions, filling slots (incl. the family's own ads), entertainment shows, and cutting labor costs. Don't pay $15M; **about $10M** works.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Naming the restaurant chain and bus company is added.

SAY

"Our client is a family business in Dubai that wants to acquire a TV channel broadcasting company. They already own and operate businesses in F&B (a restaurant chain) and transportation (a bus company)."

"Is this a good idea or not?"

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

What's the client's objective?	"A payback period of less than 5 years."
How does the channel make money?	"The only revenue stream is advertisements."
Do they have the money and expertise?	"Yes, they have the necessary expertise and capability."
Are there barriers or regulations?	"No barriers to entry."
Why do they want this channel? ADDED	"Diversification, and they think it could help their other businesses."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Pins down the goal: payback under 5 years
- [ ] Asks how the channel makes money
- [ ] Asks why they want it (finds the synergy angle)

2 Framework

2–3 min

SAY

"How would you approach this?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate should target three buckets: client, market, profitability.
- After they present it, guide them to profitability: say the client has the necessary expertise and capability and there are no barriers to entry.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Client: financial capability, expertise, conflicts with their other businesses
- [ ] Market: competitors, market leaders, potential share, barriers
- [ ] Profitability: revenue streams, prices, volume; initial investment, fixed and variable costs

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Client: financial capability to acquire
- [ ] Client: expertise
- [ ] Client: conflicts of interest with other businesses
- [ ] Market: competitors and market leaders
- [ ] Market: potential market share
- [ ] Market: barriers (regulations, policies, antitrust laws)
- [ ] Revenue streams (subscriptions, packages and bundles, ads)
- [ ] Prices of subscriptions, bundles, ads
- [ ] Volume (number of subscribers/viewers)
- [ ] Costs: initial investment, fixed costs, variable costs

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Could owning a channel conflict with their other businesses?"
- "What would you need to know about revenue?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Client (finances, expertise, conflicts of interest) / **Market** (competitors, leaders, potential share, barriers: regulations, policies, antitrust) / **Profitability** (revenue: streams, prices, volume; costs: initial investment, fixed, variable).

3 Revenue streams PARTLY ADDED

2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The streams come from the casebook's framework; asking them as a question is added.

SAY

"The client has the expertise and there are no barriers, so let's focus on profitability. How can a TV channel make money?"

HOW TO STEER

- After they list them: "For this channel, the only revenue stream today is advertising."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Advertising
- [ ] Subscriptions
- [ ] Packages and bundles
- [ ] Bonus: content licensing, sponsorship of shows

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Advertisements
- [ ] Subscriptions
- [ ] Packages and bundles

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Ads, subscriptions, packages and bundles. This channel earns only from ads, so subscriptions are a later lever.

4 Maximum ad revenue

4 min

SAY

"Here's how the channel runs. What's the yearly ad revenue?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: use a bottom-up approach to determine revenues.

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK HOW ADS ARE SOLD, OR RIGHT AWAY IF THEY'RE STUCK.

Exhibit 1. Channel operations

- Operates 24/7, **300 days** a year
- Every hour: **10 minutes of ads** and 50 minutes of shows
- Peak hours (**4 hours a day**): 1 minute of ads costs **$250**
- Non-peak hours (**20 hours a day**): 1 minute of ads costs **$100**

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Peak: 250 × 10 × 4 × 300 = $3M
- [ ] Non-peak: 100 × 10 × 20 × 300 = $6M
- [ ] Total $9M

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Peak: $250 × 10 × 4 × 300 = $3M
Non-peak: $100 × 10 × 20 × 300 = $6M
Total = $9M per year
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Start with one hour of peak time."

5 Payback

2 min

SAY

"The initial investment is $15 million, and yearly operational costs are $6 million, mainly labor. What's the payback period?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profit = 9 − 6 = $3M
- [ ] Payback = 15 ÷ 3 = 5 years
- [ ] Notes it just misses 'less than 5 years'

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Payback = Initial investment ÷ Yearly profit = 15 ÷ (9 − 6) = 5 years
```

6 Critique the result PARTLY ADDED

3–4 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The $8M actual revenue is the casebook's; the slot sell-through exhibit is added.

SAY

"Does that result make sense to you?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: ask the candidate to critique the result. They should realize the limiting factor is demand, not supply: not all ad slots are taken. Then tell them the actual yearly revenue is $8M.

GIVE ONLY WHEN: ONCE THEY QUESTION WHETHER EVERY SLOT SELLS (OR AFTER HINT 2).

Exhibit 2. Share of ad minutes actually sold last year

Peak	Non-peak
100%	~83%

Actual yearly revenue: **$8M**.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Realizes $9M assumes every slot sells: it's a ceiling
- [ ] Recalculates: 8 − 6 = $2M → 15 ÷ 2 = 7.5 years
- [ ] Says it fails the 5-year goal
- [ ] Notes peak is sold out (room to raise peak prices); non-peak has unsold slots

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Payback = 15 ÷ (8 − 6) = 7.5 years
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Is every ad minute always sold?"
2. "Is $9M what they earn, or the most they could earn?"

7 Speeding up payback

3–4 min

SAY

"How could they maximize profit to accelerate payback?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate should look at two options: increase revenues and decrease costs.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Splits into increase revenues / decrease costs
- [ ] Revenue: charge a subscription
- [ ] Revenue: raise ad demand to fill capacity
- [ ] Revenue: entertainment programs to attract viewers
- [ ] Costs: lower initial investment, labor costs, outsource or automate

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Charge a subscription
- [ ] Increase ad demand to reach full capacity: marketing
- [ ] Increase ad demand: advertise the family business (F&B and transportation)
- [ ] Increase ad demand: broadcast awareness campaigns (e.g. smoking kills, suicide hotlines)
- [ ] Host entertainment programs (e.g. 'The Voice')
- [ ] Decrease the initial investment (negotiate the price)
- [ ] Decrease labor costs
- [ ] Outsource or automate certain jobs

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "What does the family already own that could buy ads?"
- "Which cost is biggest, and how could you reduce it?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Increase revenues: subscription; fill ad capacity via marketing, the family's own businesses' ads and awareness campaigns; entertainment programs. **Decrease costs:** lower purchase price, labor costs, outsource or automate.

8 Synergies ADDED

3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The family's $1.2M ad spend is new.

SAY

"Let's size one idea. The family's restaurants and buses currently spend $1.2 million a year on TV ads on other channels. What if they moved that spend to their own channel?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] They can only fill the ~$1M of unsold non-peak slots
- [ ] For the family it's a saving, not new outside money, but it counts at group level
- [ ] Effective profit back to ~$3M → payback 5 years: still not under 5
- [ ] Questions whether non-peak slots suit restaurant ads

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Group view: $2M channel profit + ~$1M saved ad spend ≈ $3M → 5 years. Better, but still not under 5.

9 The right price ADDED

2 min

SAY

"Without counting synergies, what's the most the family should pay to pay back within five years?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] $2M a year × 5 years = $10M
- [ ] Keeps synergies as negotiating room, not the base case

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`$2M × 5 = $10M (anything below that pays back in under 5 years)`

10 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"What do you tell the family?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: don't buy at $15M
- [ ] Reasons: real payback 7.5 years; $9M is a ceiling; even moving their own ads only gets to 5
- [ ] Counter-offer around $10M, and/or lift profit: subscriptions, fill slots, entertainment shows, lower labor costs
- [ ] Next steps: seller's flexibility on price, ad market trend

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 6 OF 10

Plane Ticket Price

Pricing | Medium | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

An airline is launching Dubai–Paris and wants the ticket price that makes the most profit. The candidate maps the airline's revenue streams and costs, sorts fixed from variable, builds a demand curve and a profit formula, and finds the best price. Then they question a result that leaves the plane half empty.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Demand: **Seats = −0.1 × Price + 300**. Profit = $-0.1P^2 + 350P - 160{,}000$, maximized at **$1,750** (125 passengers, ~$146k profit per flight). But that's above competitors and only 42% full, so add **restricted discount fares** (e.g. +$30k from 75 group seats).

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: '300-seat aircraft' is from the casebook's data; nothing else added.

SAY

"Our client is an airline company based in Dubai. They want to prepare a flight from Dubai to Paris on a 300-seat aircraft."

"They want us to find the price per ticket that maximizes profit."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

How many seats on the plane?	"300 seats."
One cabin class? ADDED	"Assume a single economy cabin."
Who else flies the route? ADDED	"Two other airlines. I'll share their prices if they become relevant."
Do we know how demand reacts to price? ADDED	"Yes, we have some market research. Ask when you need it."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Plays back: one flight, find the profit-maximizing ticket price
- [ ] Asks how demand responds to price
- [ ] Asks about revenue and costs

2 Approach

2 min

SAY

"How do you want to tackle this?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: this is not a very typical profitability case. The candidate must express profit in terms of P, the ticket price, then take the derivative and set it to zero to find the maximizing price.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profit = revenue − costs
- [ ] Higher price → fewer seats sold: needs a demand relationship
- [ ] Write profit as a function of price, then find its peak
- [ ] Plans to sanity-check against competitors

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "If you raise the price, what happens to the number of passengers?"
- "What do you need to know to write profit as a formula?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Profit = Revenue − Costs. Revenue = price × seats sold, and seats depend on price. Costs = fixed + variable × seats. Write profit as a function of P, then maximize.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "If you raise the price, what happens to the number of passengers?"

3 Revenue streams PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The list is the casebook's additional information; asking for it is added.

SAY

"Before the math: what revenue streams does an airline have on a flight like this?"

HOW TO STEER

- After they list them, say: "Good. To set the ticket price, we'll focus on the ticket itself."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Ticket price
- [ ] At least 3 other streams

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Ticket price
- [ ] Extra luggage charge
- [ ] Amenities (food, Wi-Fi, seat selection)
- [ ] Advertising
- [ ] Companion fee for minor travelers
- [ ] Pet extra fee

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "What do passengers pay for besides the ticket?"
- "Who else, besides passengers, might pay the airline?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Casebook list: ticket price, extra luggage charge, amenities, advertising, companion fee for minor travelers, pet extra fee.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Think about the last time you flew. What did you pay for besides the ticket?"

4 Costs PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The list is the casebook's additional information; asking for it is added.

SAY

"And what costs does the airline have for this flight?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] At least 5 cost types
- [ ] Fuel and crew are mentioned

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] COGS (food and drinks served)
- [ ] Labor (pilots, crew)
- [ ] Maintenance
- [ ] Marketing
- [ ] Airport fees and taxes
- [ ] Fuel
- [ ] Insurance

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "What does it cost just to get the plane in the air?"
- "What do they pay the airports?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Casebook list: COGS, labor, maintenance, marketing, airport fees and taxes, fuel, insurance.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Who needs to be paid for the plane to fly?"

5 Fixed vs. variable PARTLY ADDED

2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: $10,000 fixed and $500/seat are the casebook's; the classification question is added.

SAY

"Which of those costs are fixed for the flight, and which grow with each passenger?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: AFTER THEY CLASSIFY THE COSTS.

Exhibit 1. Costs per flight

- Fixed: **$10,000**
- Variable: **$500 per seat sold**

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Mostly fixed per flight: crew, maintenance, marketing, insurance, most fuel, landing fees
- [ ] Per passenger: meals (COGS), passenger taxes and fees, some fuel (weight)
- [ ] Writes Costs = 10,000 + 500 × Seats

IF THEY SAY… YOU SAY

Says fuel is fully variable	"Does the plane burn much less fuel if it's half empty?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Costs = **$10,000 + $500 × seats sold**.

6 Demand curve

3–4 min

SAY

"Here's what our market research says about demand. What's the relationship between price and seats sold?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 2. Market research

- If **200** seats are taken → ticket price **$1,000**
- If **100** seats are taken → ticket price **$2,000**
- Assume a linear relationship

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Assumes $S = a \times P + b$
- [ ] $a = \Delta S \div \Delta P = (200 - 100) \div (1{,}000 - 2{,}000) = -0.1$
- [ ] $b = 300$ (from $200 = -0.1 \times 1{,}000 + b$)
- [ ] $S = -0.1P + 300$, and checks it

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

$a = (200 - 100) \div (1000 - 2000) = -0.1$

$200 = -0.1 \times 1000 + b \rightarrow b = 300$

$S = -0.1 \times P + 300$

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many seats do you lose for every $1,000 increase?"
2. "Try seats = a × price + b."

7 Profit formula

3 min

SAY

"Now write the flight's profit as a function of the price."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Revenue = S × P = $-0.1P^2 + 300P$
- [ ] Costs = 10,000 + 500 × (−0.1P + 300) = 160,000 − 50P
- [ ] Profit = $-0.1P^2 + 350P - 160{,}000$

IF THEY SAY... YOU SAY

Costs = 10,000 + 500 × 300	"Do we pay $500 for every seat, or only for seats sold?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Revenues: $S \times P = -0.1P^2 + 300P$

Costs: $10{,}000 + 500 \times (-0.1P + 300) = 160{,}000 - 50P$

Profit: $-0.1P^2 + 350P - 160{,}000$

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Write revenue using price only, by replacing S."

8 Best price

3 min

SAY

"What price maximizes profit?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: take the derivative of the profit expression and set it to zero. If the candidate doesn't use calculus, testing a few prices ($1,500 / $1,750 / $2,000) to find the peak is also fine.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] dProfit/dP = −0.2P + 350 = 0
- [ ] P = 350 ÷ 0.2 = $1,750
- [ ] At $1,750: 125 seats, profit ≈ $146k

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
dProfit/dP = −0.2P + 350 = 0 → P = $1,750
Seats = −0.1 × 1,750 + 300 = 125
Profit = 218,750 − 72,500 = $146,250
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Profit rises then falls. Where's the top?"
2. "You could test a few prices around $1,500–2,000."

9 Sanity check ADDED

3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Competitor fares are new.

SAY

"Here's what the two competitors charge. Does $1,750 still make sense?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 3. Competitor fares, Dubai–Paris economy

Airline	Average fare	Flights per day
Competitor A	$1,450	3
Competitor B	$1,600	2

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] We'd be the most expensive with the fewest flights: risky
- [ ] The research demand curve may not hold once customers compare prices
- [ ] Only 125 of 300 seats filled (42%), very low for an airline
- [ ] Suggests validating demand, or a reason to pay more (service, schedule)

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The math is right but the result is fragile. A strong candidate doesn't just defend the formula.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How full is the plane at $1,750?"

10 The empty seats ADDED

3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The tour-operator offer is new.

SAY

"175 seats fly empty. Could they earn from them without lowering the main fare? For example, a tour operator offers to buy 75 seats at $900 each, on dates it picks. What's that worth per flight?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 75 × ($900 − $500) = $30,000 more profit
- [ ] Risk: full-fare customers switching to cheap seats; manage with restrictions (no refunds, fixed dates, early booking)
- [ ] Links back to the other revenue streams: luggage, amenities, companion and pet fees

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
75 × (900 − 500) = $30,000 per flight
```

This is how airlines really price: several fare classes with restrictions, plus extra fees.

11 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"What do you tell the airline?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: a $1,750 headline fare, plus restricted discount fares to fill seats
- [ ] Reasons: maximizes single-fare profit (~$146k), the discount tier adds ~$30k, extra fees add more
- [ ] Risks: priced above competitors, low load factor
- [ ] Next steps: test demand at launch, design fare rules to prevent cannibalization

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 7 OF 10

Energy Consumption

Discussion | Hard | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A Gulf energy ministry wants a program to reduce national energy use. The candidate structures it by sector, brainstorms ways to cut consumption in homes and businesses, industry and transport, sizes one lever with data, and handles the politics of raising prices.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Casebook framework: **sectors / consumption reduction / feasibility / profitability** (the last two are skipped). Ideas per sector come from the casebook. Added: homes are 40% of use and AC is 70% of that; one AC program saves only **~2.5%**, so they need a **package** (pricing, efficiency, regulation, transport).

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The 10% target, 5% growth and subsidies are added.

SAY

"The ministry of energy of a GCC country has hired you to design a program to reduce the overall energy consumption of the country. They'd like a 10% cut within five years; consumption has grown about 5% a year, and electricity and fuel are heavily subsidized."

"How do you approach the problem?"

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Is 10% against today's level? ADDED	"Yes, 10% below today's consumption within five years."
How cheap is energy today? ADDED	"Electricity and fuel are heavily subsidized, among the cheapest in the world."
Any constraints? ADDED	"Sharp price increases are politically sensitive."
Do we have data by sector? ADDED	"Yes. Ask when you need it."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Pins down the target (10% in 5 years)
- [ ] Spots that subsidies drive overuse
- [ ] Asks about political constraints

2 Framework

3 min

SAY

"How would you structure the program?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate should target four buckets: major consumption sectors, consumption reduction, feasibility analysis, profitability analysis.
- After they present it, say: "In the interest of time, we won't explore feasibility and profitability. Let's focus on ways to reduce energy use in each sector."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Major consumption sectors: residential, commercial and entertainment, industrial, transportation
- [ ] Consumption reduction: levers for each sector
- [ ] Feasibility: engineering, expertise, available technology
- [ ] Profitability: cost-benefit, incl. non-financial benefits (lower CO_2, cleaner air)

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Sectors: residential
- [ ] Sectors: commercial and entertainment
- [ ] Sectors: industrial
- [ ] Sectors: transportation
- [ ] Consumption reduction for each sector
- [ ] Feasibility: engineering feasibility
- [ ] Feasibility: expertise
- [ ] Feasibility: available technology
- [ ] Profitability: cost-benefit analysis incl. CO_2 and cleaner air

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Who uses energy in a country?"
- "Once you have ideas, how would you choose between them?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Major consumption sectors (residential, commercial and entertainment, industrial, transportation) / **Consumption reduction** (levers per sector) / **Feasibility** (engineering, expertise, technology) / **Profitability** (cost-benefit, incl. CO_2 and cleaner air).

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Who uses energy in a country?"

3 Where the energy goes ADDED

3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Both exhibits are new.

SAY

"Before brainstorming, here's the breakdown. Where would you focus first?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK FOR DATA, OR RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 1. Energy use by sector

Sector	Share
Residential	40%
Industrial	30%
Transportation	20%
Commercial and entertainment	10%

Exhibit 2. Residential use by purpose

Air conditioning	Appliances	Lighting	Other
70%	15%	10%	5%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Residential is the biggest sector
- [ ] Home air conditioning = 70% × 40% = 28% of national use
- [ ] Focuses there first

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Home air conditioning alone is ~28% of national consumption: the biggest single target.

4 Homes, offices and venues

3–4 min

SAY

"How would you reduce consumption in the residential, commercial and entertainment sectors?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Price: raise the cost per kWh
- [ ] Efficiency: discounts and free installation of efficient appliances
- [ ] Technology: sensors, fewer bulbs, consolidated cooling
- [ ] Groups ideas (price / technology / behavior)

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Increase the cost of electricity per kWh
- [ ] Free installation and discounts on energy-efficient home appliances
- [ ] Sensors so lights turn off when a room is empty
- [ ] Reduce the number of unnecessary light bulbs in buildings
- [ ] Consolidate the cooling systems in buildings

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "What makes people use less of anything?"
- "What technology could help without changing habits?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Casebook list: raise price per kWh; free installation and discounts on efficient appliances; light sensors; fewer unnecessary bulbs; consolidated cooling systems.

5 Size one lever ADDED

3 min

SAY

"Let's size one idea. Suppose 30% of homes switch to efficient AC units that use 30% less energy. How much would national consumption fall?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 40% × 70% × 30% × 30% ≈ 2.5%
- [ ] Says clearly: one quarter of the 10% target
- [ ] Concludes they need several levers together

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`0.40 × 0.70 × 0.30 × 0.30 = 2.52%`

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What share of national energy is home AC?"

6 Industrial sector

2–3 min

SAY

"What about the industrial sector?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Price and taxation on big consumers
- [ ] Efficient machines
- [ ] Operating hours
- [ ] R&D incentives

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Increase the cost of electricity per kWh
- [ ] Higher taxation and regulation on big consumers of energy
- [ ] Free installation and discounts on energy-efficient machines
- [ ] Reduce operating hours
- [ ] Incentives for companies with R&D departments that find ways to cut energy use

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "How could the government reward companies that save energy?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Casebook list: raise price per kWh; tax and regulate big consumers; discounts on efficient machines; reduce operating hours; incentives for energy-saving R&D.

7 Transportation sector

2–3 min

SAY

"And transportation?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Fuel and car prices
- [ ] License and toll costs
- [ ] Car-pooling and public transport
- [ ] Electric and hybrid charging

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Increase car fuel prices
- [ ] Increase the price of cars to encourage public transportation
- [ ] Increase the costs and taxes of driving licenses and car licenses
- [ ] Increase charges at toll stations
- [ ] Encourage car-pooling programs
- [ ] Install charging stations for hybrid and electric cars

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "How could you get people to drive less?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Casebook list: raise fuel prices; raise car prices to push public transport; higher license costs and taxes; higher tolls; car-pooling; charging stations for hybrid/electric cars.

8 The politics ADDED

3 min

SAY

"Many of your ideas raise prices, which is politically sensitive here. How would you handle that?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Gradual increases over several years
- [ ] Tiered pricing: cheap first block, higher prices for heavy users
- [ ] Support for low-income households
- [ ] Use subsidy savings to fund efficient-equipment rebates
- [ ] Clear public communication

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

A strong answer protects ordinary households while making heavy users pay more.

9 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"The minister has one minute. What's your program?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: a package of measures, not one lever
- [ ] Priority 1: home AC (28% of use): efficiency standards and rebates
- [ ] Priority 2: gradual tiered pricing that protects low-income homes
- [ ] Priority 3: industry and transport measures from the brainstorm
- [ ] Next steps: feasibility and cost-benefit of each lever (the buckets we skipped); size the package to reach 10%; pilot

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 8 OF 10

KSA Retail Bank

Profitability | Hard | ~30 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A large Saudi bank's revenue has been falling for two years. The candidate finds which product category is shrinking, recognizes what the percentages can and can't tell us, then sizes a cross-selling plan between credit cards and personal loans.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Category 1 (personal loans and cards) is the problem: its share fell **and** total revenue fell. Categories 2 and 3 are **undetermined** from shares alone. Fix: cross-sell to existing customers: **$5.25M** (cards to loan holders) + $18.75M = **$24M**. Added: with dollar totals, Category 1 lost $100M, mostly customers leaving for digital banks, so cross-selling covers only a quarter.

1 Read the prompt

2–3 min

SAY

"Our client is one of the largest retail banks in KSA. They have been facing a decline in revenues for the past two years."

"They have hired us to find the reason and provide them with a solution."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

How does the bank make money?	"Revenue falls into three categories: (1) personal loans and credit cards, (2) car loans, (3) house loans. I'll give you the split."
How did competitors do? ADDED	"Traditional banks are roughly stable. A few new digital banks entered two years ago."
Any regulatory changes? ADDED	"Nothing significant."
What's the CEO's goal? ADDED	"Stop the decline and get revenue growing again."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks how the bank makes money (the 3 categories)
- [ ] Asks about competitors

2 Framework

3 min

SAY

"Here's how revenue splits across the three categories. How would you structure this?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: in this case the numbers are given before the framework. Show the mix table now.
- The candidate should take an external-internal approach to be MECE.
- After they present it, say: "The problem is only internal."

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY, WITH THE QUESTION.

Exhibit 1. Revenue mix

	Cat. 1: Personal loans and credit cards	Cat. 2: Car loans	Cat. 3: House l
2 years ago	55%	28%	17%
Now	50%	30%	20%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] External, economic: disposable income, interest rates, new regulations
- [ ] External, market: competitors facing the same issue? their services, market shares
- [ ] Internal: revenue streams, prices and fees, volume (customers), product mix

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Economic: decrease in customer disposable income
- [ ] Economic: change in interest rates
- [ ] Economic: new regulations in the financial sector
- [ ] Market: are competitors facing the same issue?
- [ ] Market: services offered by competitors
- [ ] Market: market share of client and leaders
- [ ] Internal: revenue streams (credit and debit cards, return on loans, money exchange fees)
- [ ] Internal: prices and fees: up or down?
- [ ] Internal: volume: more or fewer customers?
- [ ] Internal: product mix: % of revenue streams

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Could something outside the bank explain this?"
- "Inside the bank, what could make revenue fall?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

External: economic (disposable income, interest rates, regulation) and market (competitors, their services, market shares). **Internal**: revenue streams, prices and fees, volume, product mix.

3 Which category?

3 min

SAY

"The problem is only internal. Which category is behind the decline? And what can you say about the other two?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate should say Category 1, NOT ONLY because its share dropped 5 points BUT ALSO because the total revenue dropped.
- Then ask about Categories 2 and 3: the candidate should say it's undetermined whether they rose or fell, because their change is relative to a shrinking total.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Category 1: its share fell AND the total fell, so it certainly shrank in dollars
- [ ] Categories 2 and 3: undetermined; a bigger share of a smaller total could be up or down
- [ ] Asks for the actual dollar totals

IF THEY SAY… YOU SAY

"Car and house loans grew"	"They grew as a share. Did they grow in dollars?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Category 1, for two reasons: its share fell and the total fell. Categories 2 and 3: **undetermined** from percentages alone.

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "If the total shrank, did Category 1 shrink in dollars?"
2. "Car loans went from 28% to 30% of a smaller total. Did they grow?"

4 In dollars ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The $1.0B and $900M totals are new.

SAY

"Good. The CFO just sent the totals: revenue went from $1.0 billion two years ago to $900 million now. What does each category look like in dollars?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Category 1: $550M → $450M (–$100M)
- [ ] Car loans: $280M → $270M (–$10M)
- [ ] House loans: $170M → $180M (+$10M)
- [ ] Category 1 explains the entire decline

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Cat. 1: 550 → 450 = −$100M
Cat. 2: 280 → 270 = −$10M
Cat. 3: 170 → 180 = +$10M
```

5 Customers or price? ADDED

3 min

SAY

"Let's dig into Category 1. Is it fewer customers or less revenue per customer?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 2. Personal loans and credit cards

	2 years ago	Now
Customers	600,000	500,000
Revenue per customer	~$917	$900

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Lost 100k customers (−17%)
- [ ] Revenue per customer nearly flat (−2%)
- [ ] So it's a customer-loss problem, not pricing

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

The bank is losing customers. Next question: where are they going?

6 Why are they leaving? ADDED

3 min

SAY

"The bank surveyed customers who closed their accounts. Before you read it, summarize where we are."

GIVE ONLY WHEN: AFTER THEY SUMMARIZE.

Exhibit 3. Why former customers left

Reason	Share
Moved to a digital bank (instant approval, better app)	50%
Lower card fees elsewhere	30%
Moved abroad, other	20%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Crisp summary: revenue –$100M, all in Category 1, driven by lost customers
- [ ] Digital experience is the main issue, fees second
- [ ] Links to the digital banks that entered two years ago

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Mid-case summary example: "Revenue fell $100M, all from personal loans and cards, because we lost 100k customers, mostly to digital banks."

7 Existing or new customers?

2 min

SAY

"How could the bank increase Category 1 revenue? Is it easier to sell more to existing customers or to acquire new ones?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: two ways: sell more to existing customers, or acquire new ones. The candidate should say existing customers is easier: banks have high retention, and people with fixed deposits and loans can't move accounts easily.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Two ways: sell more to existing customers, or acquire new ones
- [ ] Existing is easier: high retention, deposits and loans tie customers to the bank

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Selling more to **existing customers** is easier: high retention; fixed deposits and loans make switching hard.

8 Cross-selling

2 min

SAY

"What are some ways to sell more to existing customers?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: most importantly, cross-selling: credit cards to personal loan owners and vice versa.
- Then say: "Because of time, let's focus only on the extra revenue from selling credit cards to personal loan owners."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Cross-selling: credit cards to personal-loan customers, and loans to card holders
- [ ] Other ideas: bundles, loyalty rewards, pre-approved offers, upgrading card tiers

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Cross-sell credit cards to personal loan owners
- [ ] Cross-sell personal loans to credit card owners

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Above all, **cross-selling** between credit cards and personal loans.

9 Size the cross-sell

5 min

SAY

"How much extra yearly revenue would come from selling credit cards to customers who only have a personal loan?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 4. Category 1 customers

- 500,000 customers: **30%** personal loans only, **50%** credit cards only, **20%** both
- Only **10%** of personal-loan-only customers are interested in credit cards
- On average, each customer spends **$20,000** per year
- On average, **5%** of customers default on credit card payments
- Credit card fees: **$250** annual fee; **10%** charge for customers who default

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 150k loan-only → 10% interested = 15,000
- [ ] Annual fee: 15,000 × $250 = $3.75M
- [ ] Default charge: 15,000 × 5% × $20,000 × 10% = $1.5M
- [ ] Total $5.25M

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Loan-only: 30% × 500k = 150k → 10% = 15,000
Annual fee: 15,000 × 250 = $3.75M
Default fee: 15,000 × 0.05 × 20,000 × 0.1 = $1.5M
Total = $5.25M
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many customers have only a personal loan?"
2. "There are two fees. Do them one at a time."

10 Total upside PARTLY ADDED

2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: $18.75M and $24M are the casebook's; the comparison with the $100M gap is added.

SAY

"Cross-selling the other way around, personal loans to card owners, generates $18.75 million. What's the total, and is it enough?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] $3.75M + $1.5M + $18.75M = $24M
- [ ] Compares with the $100M lost: about a quarter
- [ ] So the bank must also stop customers leaving

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
3.75 + 1.5 + 18.75 = $24M (≈ 24% of the $100M lost)
```

11 Recommendation PARTLY ADDED

1–2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: Cross-selling and checking other categories are the casebook's; fixing digital churn is added.

SAY

"The CEO has two minutes. What do you recommend?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: recommend going ahead with the cross-selling strategy, but also look more deeply into the other categories, as they might also be behind the decline.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: go ahead with cross-selling (~$24M a year)
- [ ] Also look deeper at Categories 2 and 3
- [ ] Fix the root cause: customers leaving for digital banks (app, instant approval, fees)
- [ ] Next steps: identify customers at risk of leaving

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 9 OF 10

Lebanese Cryptocurrency

Market entry | Medium | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A Lebanese startup wants to launch its own cryptocurrency. The candidate sizes how many people could use it, how many transactions they'd make and the profit, explains why margins are thin, and judges payback and risks.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

~**240k users** (40% of 600k crypto users), **624k transactions a week**, revenue ~$612k and **profit ~$61,200 a week** at a 10% margin. Thin margin: setup, validation and customer acquisition costs. Added: $5M back in ~1.6 years, but that needs ~126k users.

1 Read the prompt PARTLY ADDED

2–3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The banking-crisis context is added.

SAY

"Our client is a startup that wants to create a cryptocurrency to be used in Lebanon. Since the banking crisis, many Lebanese have lost trust in banks."

"They have hired you to find out whether this is a good idea."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

Does the client have the skills and funding?	"Yes, they have the necessary expertise and are financially capable."
Who are the competitors?	"One major competitor: Bitcoin, which controls 60% of the market. The other 40% is untapped."
What does success look like? ADDED	"They want to recover their $5 million initial investment within three years."
Is it legal? ADDED	"The central bank hasn't banned it, but there are no clear rules either."
How does the coin make money?	"Transaction fees. I'll give you details."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks about the client's capabilities
- [ ] Asks about competitors (Bitcoin 60%)
- [ ] Asks how the coin makes money

2 Framework

2–3 min

SAY

"What's your framework?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate should target three buckets: client, market, profitability.
- After they present it, say: "The client has the expertise and is financially capable. There's one main competitor, Bitcoin, with 60% of the market and an untapped 40%. Let's estimate the crypto market size in Lebanon."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Client: experience and expertise in crypto; financial capability
- [ ] Market: size of crypto in Lebanon; competitors and shares; barriers (legislation, regulation, distribution)
- [ ] Profitability: revenue streams (fixed fees, commissions), prices, volume; costs (initial investment, fixed and variable)

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Client: previous experience and expertise in crypto
- [ ] Client: financial capability to back the idea
- [ ] Market: size of crypto in Lebanon
- [ ] Market: competitors and their market shares
- [ ] Market: barriers (legislation, regulations, access to distribution)
- [ ] Profitability: revenue streams (fixed fees, transaction commissions)
- [ ] Profitability: prices and fees
- [ ] Profitability: volume (expected customers)
- [ ] Costs: initial investment
- [ ] Costs: operating expenditures, fixed and variable

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "What could stop a new coin from being allowed or adopted?"
- "How exactly would the coin earn money?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Client (expertise, finances) / **Market** (size, competitors and shares, barriers: legislation, regulation, distribution) / **Profitability** (revenues: fees, commissions, prices, volume; costs: initial investment, opex).

3 Key factors

2 min

SAY

"Before you size the market: what determines whether someone in Lebanon would use crypto?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Age
- [ ] Income
- [ ] Risk appetite
- [ ] Tech literacy
- [ ] Ability to trade
- [ ] Knowledge of crypto

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Age
- [ ] Income
- [ ] Risk appetite
- [ ] Tech literacy
- [ ] Ability to trade
- [ ] Knowledge of crypto

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "Who's more likely to use crypto: a 25-year-old or a 70-year-old? Why?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Casebook key factors: age, income, risk appetite, tech literacy, ability to trade, knowledge of crypto. We'll segment by age, then by income.

4 How many users?

4 min

SAY

"Let's size it. How many people could use the coin?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT POPULATION OR ADOPTION, OR IF THEIR ESTIMATES ARE FAR OFF.

Exhibit 1. Lebanon: ~**6 million** people, spread evenly from age 0 to 80

Age group	0–20	21–40	41–60	61–80
Share into crypto	10%	25%	5%	0%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 1.5M per age group
- [ ] 150k + 375k + 75k + 0 = 600k into crypto
- [ ] × 40% untapped = 240k: the maximum available market

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
1.5M × (10% + 25% + 5% + 0%) = 600k into crypto
600k × 40% = 240k maximum available market
```

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "How many people are in each age group?"
2. "Bitcoin has 60%. What's left?"

5 Transactions

3 min

SAY

"How many transactions per week would those users make?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT USAGE OR INCOME.

Exhibit 2. Income-based distribution of the population

Income level	Share	Transactions per week
High	10%	7
Medium	50%	3
Low	40%	1

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] High: 240k × 10% × 7 = 168k
- [ ] Medium: 240k × 50% × 3 = 360k
- [ ] Low: 240k × 40% × 1 = 96k
- [ ] Total 624k a week

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
168k + 360k + 96k = 624k transactions per week
```

6 Profit

4 min

SAY

"Here's how the coin charges. What's the expected profit per week?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 3. Fees

- A fixed added charge of **$0.50** on all transactions
- Plus a commission by transaction size:

Transaction size	Commission	Share of transaction volume
$0–10k	$0.60	50%
$10k–100k	$0.40	40%
> $100k	$0.20	10%

Profit margin: **10%**.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Fixed charge: $0.50 × 624k = $312k
- [ ] Commission: (0.5×0.6 + 0.4×0.4 + 0.1×0.2) × 624k ≈ $300k
- [ ] Revenue ≈ $612k a week
- [ ] Profit = 10% ≈ $61,200 a week

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
$0.50 × 624k = $312k
$0.48 × 624k ≈ $300k
Revenue ≈ $612k → × 10% = $61,200 expected profit per week
```

7 Why only 10%?

2–3 min

SAY

"Why do you think the profit margin is only 10% and not more?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate should realize they're being asked why the costs are so high.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Realizes the question is really about high costs
- [ ] High initial investment: licenses and approvals, a location for the equipment, servers, cooling
- [ ] High cost to validate transactions on the blockchain
- [ ] High customer acquisition cost vs. Bitcoin

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Licenses and approvals
- [ ] A location to host the equipment
- [ ] Servers
- [ ] High cooling expenses (CPUs constantly mining)
- [ ] High cost to validate transactions on the blockchain
- [ ] Customer acquisition cost to win users from established coins like Bitcoin

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "What does it cost to run a cryptocurrency?"
- "How expensive is it to win a user away from Bitcoin?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Costs are high: initial investment (licenses, location, servers, cooling), blockchain validation costs, and customer acquisition against Bitcoin.

8 Payback PARTLY ADDED 2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The casebook says to compare the investment with yearly profit; the $5M and 3-year goal are added.

SAY

"The client's initial investment is $5 million and they want it back within three years. Do they get there?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] $61.2k × 52 ≈ $3.2M a year
- [ ] $5M ÷ $3.2M ≈ 1.6 years: within 3

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`61.2k × 52 ≈ $3.18M a year → 5 ÷ 3.18 ≈ 1.6 years`

9 Stress test ADDED

3 min

SAY

"That assumes we win all 240,000 users. How many users do we actually need to hit the three-year goal?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Profit per user ≈ $3.18M ÷ 240k ≈ $13 a year
- [ ] Need ~$1.67M a year → ~126k users
- [ ] Over half the untapped market: ambitious for a new coin
- [ ] Notes new competitors would shrink the 40%

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`$5M ÷ 3 ≈ $1.67M a year`
`$1.67M ÷ ~$13.3 per user ≈ 126k users (~52% of 240k)`

10 Recommendation PARTLY ADDED

1–2 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: The casebook's caveats are kept; the 126k-user threshold is added.

SAY

"So, is this a good idea?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: it seems profitable, but any other competitor entering will decrease the 40% share we assumed. Compare the initial investment to yearly profit for payback, and look at ways to cut costs and raise the margin.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: looks profitable (~$61k a week, ~$3.2M a year)
- [ ] Risk: new competitors would shrink our 40%; we need ~126k users
- [ ] Compare investment with profit: ~1.6-year payback in the best case
- [ ] Work on costs to raise the 10% margin
- [ ] Next steps: pilot, engage the central bank on rules

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

CASE 10 OF 10

Hair Loss Pill

Profitability | Medium | ~25 min

WHAT THIS CASE IS ABOUT (READ THIS YOURSELF)

A company invented a single pill that cures hair loss and wants to sell it in Lebanon. The candidate chooses a pricing strategy, sizes how many people want and can afford the pill, estimates first-year revenue, then judges whether it's profitable.

THE ANSWER IN ONE LINE, DON'T SHOW

Price at **1.5–2× a transplant: $7,500–10,000** (value + competitor based). ~**1M** interested (mostly men) → **220k** can afford it → 20% early adopters → **$330M** in year one. Not necessarily profitable: high R&D and a possibly overestimated price. Added: with costs, year-one profit ~$286M.

1 Read the prompt

2–3 min

SAY

"Our client created a pill that reverses hair loss, and they want to sell it in Lebanon."

"They have hired you to estimate the revenues of the first year."

"Do you have any questions before you start?"

IF THEY ASK… YOU ANSWER

How many pills does someone need?	"Only one pill is needed to cure a person suffering from hair loss."
Any competitors?	"No direct competitors. However, indirect competitors offering hair treatment and transplants can be a threat when it comes to pricing."
What do alternatives cost?	"The average cost of a hair transplant is $5,000."
What did development cost? ADDED	"We'll come back to that."
Can they make enough pills? ADDED	"Yes, capacity isn't a constraint."
Anything else	"Not important for this case. Make an assumption."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Asks how many pills are needed (just one)
- [ ] Asks about alternatives and their price ($5,000 transplant)

2 Framework

2 min

SAY

"How would you structure this?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: Revenue = Price × Volume. The candidate should target 2 buckets: price and volume.
- After they present it, say: "There are no competitors selling the same product."

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Revenue = Price × Volume
- [ ] Price: price per pill, number of pills for full treatment, pricing strategy
- [ ] Volume: market size in Lebanon, market share

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] Price per pill
- [ ] Number of pills needed for full treatment
- [ ] Pricing strategy: cost-based
- [ ] Pricing strategy: value-based
- [ ] Pricing strategy: competitor-based
- [ ] Volume: market size in Lebanon
- [ ] Volume: market share (if any competitors)

ASK IF THEIR ANSWER IS THIN

- "How would you decide the price?"
- "How many people might buy it?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Price (price per pill, pills per treatment, pricing strategy: cost-, value- or competitor-based) / **Volume** (market size in Lebanon, market share).

3 Pricing strategy

2–3 min

SAY

"Which pricing strategy would you use, and why?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate should realize the pill has a lot of value (one pill, a lifetime cure), so pricing should be a mix of value-based and competitor-based. Indirect competitors (treatments and transplants) are a threat on price.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Value-based: one pill, lifetime cure → high value
- [ ] Competitor-based: anchor on the $5,000 transplant
- [ ] Explains why cost-based is weak here (cost is tiny vs. value)

IF THEY SAY… YOU SAY

"Cost-based: cost plus a margin"	"The pill costs very little to make. Would that capture what it's worth to patients?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

A mix of **value-based** (lifetime cure from one pill) and **competitor-based** (the $5,000 transplant sets the reference).

4 Price

2 min

SAY

"So what price would you charge?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] 1.5–2× the transplant price
- [ ] $7,500–10,000

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Casebook: anywhere from **1.5 to 2 times** the transplant price, so **$7,500 to $10,000**. Then say: "Let's use $7,500."

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "What do people pay today to fix hair loss?"

5 Who wants it

4 min

SAY

"Let's use $7,500. How many people in Lebanon would be interested in the pill?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate should consider that interested people are mostly men, since they suffer more from hair loss, but some women might be interested too and should be counted.

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY ASK ABOUT POPULATION OR WHO HAS HAIR LOSS.

Exhibit 1. Interest by age and gender

Age	Men	% interested	Women	% interested
0–20	0.75M	0%	0.75M	0%
21–40	0.75M	20%	0.75M	0%
41–60	0.75M	50%	0.75M	5%
61–80	0.75M	40%	0.75M	20%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Mostly men, but includes women
- [ ] Men: 150k + 375k + 300k = 825k
- [ ] Women: 37.5k + 150k = 187.5k
- [ ] Total ≈ 1.01M → round to 1M

IF THEY SAY… YOU SAY

Counts only men	"Could any women be interested?"

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

```
Men: 150k + 375k + 300k = 825k
Women: 37.5k + 150k = 187.5k
Market size ≈ 1.0125M → ~1M
```

6 Who can afford it

3 min

SAY

"Can all of them afford it?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: an income segmentation approach should be used; the pill is rarely affordable for lower-income people.

GIVE ONLY WHEN: WHEN THEY RAISE INCOME.

Exhibit 2. Affordability by income

Income level	Share of population	Share that can afford the pill
High	10%	100%
Medium	40%	30%
Low	50%	0%

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Brings up income segmentation
- [ ] High: 100k; Medium: 400k × 30% = 120k; Low: 0
- [ ] Total 220k

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`1M → 100k high (100%) + 400k medium (30% = 120k) + 500k low (0%) = 220k`

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Is $7,500 affordable for everyone in Lebanon?"

7 Year-one revenue

3 min

SAY

"Will all 220,000 buy the pill in the first year? What's year-one revenue?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate should realize only early adopters and innovators buy in year one. Assume they're 20% of the people interested.

GIVE ONLY WHEN: ONCE THEY SAY NOT EVERYONE BUYS RIGHT AWAY.

Assume early adopters and innovators, **20%**, buy in year one.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Only early adopters buy in year one
- [ ] 220k × 20% × $7,500 = $330M

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`220k × 0.2 × $7,500 = $330M`

IF THEY'RE STUCK: ONE HINT AT A TIME

1. "Does everyone buy a new product in its first year?"

8 Is it profitable?

3 min

SAY

"Is this a profitable idea?"

HOW TO STEER

- Casebook: the candidate should quickly realize the $330M doesn't necessarily reflect profitability, for 2 main reasons.

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Revenue isn't profit
- [ ] R&D to develop the pill is likely very high: breakeven may take years
- [ ] Some assumptions may be overestimated, like the price: maybe not 1.5–2× a transplant if results are similar

FULL LIST FROM THE AUBCC CASEBOOK: TICK WHAT THEY COVERED

- [ ] High R&D cost: a few years to break even
- [ ] Price may be overestimated: speed and ease may not justify a 50–100% premium

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

Not necessarily: (1) R&D was likely very high, so breakeven takes years; (2) the price may be too high: the pill's advantage is speed and ease, which may not justify a 50–100% premium over a transplant with similar results.

9 Year-one profit ADDED

3 min

Beyond the AUBCC casebook: R&D, manufacturing and marketing figures are new.

SAY

"Let's put numbers on it. Here are the costs. What's year-one profit, and how much of the R&D does it recover?"

GIVE ONLY WHEN: RIGHT AWAY.

Exhibit 3. Costs

- R&D already spent: **$400M**
- Manufacturing: **$100** per pill
- Marketing and distribution: **$40M** a year

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Manufacturing: 44k × $100 = $4.4M
- [ ] Profit ≈ 330 − 4.4 − 40 = $285.6M
- [ ] Recovers ~70% of R&D in year one
- [ ] Notes one pill per person: the Lebanese market shrinks after early adopters

ANSWER KEY, DON'T SHOW

`330 − 4.4 − 40 = $285.6M (≈ 71% of the $400M R&D)`

10 Recommendation ADDED

1–2 min

SAY

"What do you tell the CEO?"

LISTEN FOR: TICK WHAT YOU HEAR

- [ ] Answer first: ~$330M year-one revenue at ~$7,500; ~$286M profit
- [ ] Caveats: R&D, price premium may not hold, one-time purchase
- [ ] Next steps: test price sensitivity, plan other countries, financing for middle-income buyers

Score this case

Use the ticks above and the rubric. 3 = would pass.

Structure 1 2 3 4 5

Clear, tailored framework?

Math 1 2 3 4 5

Correct, clean, said out loud?

Business sense 1 2 3 4 5

Found the insight, said "so what"?

Communication 1 2 3 4 5

Answer-first, clear, confident?

Drive 1 2 3 4 5

Led the case; few hints needed?

Total: – / 25

2 STRENGTHS · 2 THINGS TO FIX

Strength: ... / Fix: ...

OPTIONAL WARM-UP, 5–10 MINUTES

Fit questions

Real interviews often start with 2–3 personal questions before the case. Ask one or two. Good answers last 1–2 minutes and tell a story.

Ask	A good answer...
"Tell me about yourself."	A 1–2 minute story, not a CV list: studies, 1–2 experiences, why consulting, one personal detail that makes them memorable.
"Why consulting?"	Specific reasons tied to their own experience (problem-solving, variety, learning). Shows they know what the job really is.
"Why our firm?"	Names something specific: people they've met, a program, values. Not just "prestige".
"Give me an example of leadership."	A real situation, what THEY did and why, the result, and what they learned. Admits a shortcoming.
"What are your three biggest weaknesses?"	Real weaknesses, not humble-brags, each with what they're doing to improve.
"Tell me about a time you challenged yourself."	A clear challenge, the steps they took, the outcome.
"Why should we give you an offer?"	2–3 confident reasons linked to what consultants actually do.
"Why aren't you working in the field of your major?"	A positive story about moving toward consulting, not running away from their major.

Red flags in fit answers

- Over 2 minutes long
- Sounds memorized word for word
- Lists facts from the CV with no story
- Can't say why consulting specifically